

EDUCATION

University of California, San Diego (UCSD), La Jolla, CA

Summa Cum Laude

B.S., *Clinical Psychology, with Highest Distinction in Honors*

B.S., *Cognitive Science with a Specialization in Cognitive Behavioral Neuroscience*

Sep 2021 – June 2025

cGPA: 3.99 / 4.00

- Advisor: Dr. Dawn Schiehser
- Honors Thesis: *Automated Mild Cognitive Impairment Detection (PD-MCIx) in patients with Parkinson's Disease*

PUBLICATIONS

1. Dong, Y., Hung, J., Xie, C., Kiyonaga, A. Pupillary signatures of working memory content are flexible to visual vs. Semantic task demands. *(to be submitted in December)*, 2025.
2. Schiehser, D., Xie, C., Adler, J., Lin, A. Mindfulness Based Stress Reduction (MBSR) for Cognitive Improvement in Parkinson's disease: A Longitudinal Randomized Controlled Trial. *(to be submitted in December)*, 2025.
3. Xie, C., Adler, J., Petkus, A., Schiehser, D. Progression of Cognitive Decline in Individuals with Parkinson's Disease. *(in Prep)*, 2025.
4. Xie, C., Mao, Y., Park, A., Geller, E. Memory and Emotion: How Prior Emotional Facial Expressions Affect Our First Impression of Niceness. *Journal of Undergraduate Psychological Research*, 2024.

POSTERS

1. Xie, C., Gitelman, D., Adler, J., Schiehser, D. Automated Mild Cognitive Impairment Detection (PD-MCIx) in patients with Parkinson's Disease. *Presentation at Society for Neuroscience*, San Diego, CA, 2025.
2. Xie, C., Chen, E., Adler, J., Carillo, A., Lin, A., Longardner, K., Schiehser, D. Cognitive Diagnostic Categorization of Parkinson's Disease patients with and without Traumatic Brain Injury. ***Presidential Poster Session.** *American Geriatrics Society (AGS) Annual Meeting, Journal of the American Geriatrics Society*, 73(S1), S112. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jgs.19450>, Chicago, IL, 2025.
3. Dong, Y., Hung, Y., Xie, C., Kiyonaga, A. Testing the flexibility of pupillary working memory signals to visual and semantic task demands. *Vision Sciences Society (VSS) Annual Meeting, Journal of Vision*, 25(9), 2871. <https://doi.org/10.1167/jov.25.9.2871>, St. Pete Beach, FL, 2025.
4. Xie, C., Geller, E. Relationships Between Sexual Orientation, State Political Affiliation, and Sex Drive. *Honors Poster Session*, San Diego, CA, 2024.

PROFESSIONAL TALKS

1. Xie, C., Gitelman, D., Adler, J., Schiehser, D. Automated Mild Cognitive Impairment Detection (PD-MCIx) in patients with Parkinson's Disease. *Undergraduate Research Conference*, San Diego, CA, 2025.
2. Adler, J., Xie, C., Schiehser, D. TBI+: The Interplay of TBI and Neurodegenerative Disease. *Center of Excellence for Stress and Mental Health*, Virtual, 2025.

OTHER PROJECTS

1. Xie, C., Ganis and Kievit Mental Rotation Replication Study. *GitHub Repository*, 2024.

CNS Laboratory of Memory and Brain Study Coordinator

| VA San Diego Healthcare

July 2025 - Present

Advisors: Christine Smith, Ph.D., Associate Professor of Psychiatry; Lisa Delano-Wood, Ph.D., Professor of Psychiatry

- Administration and scoring of neuropsychological assessments (TOMM, BVMT, D-KEFS, RUFF, WMS-IV, WRAT-4, CVLT-II, WCST-64, WAIS, NAB, MINS) to examine novel cognitive and neuroimaging white matter measures in Veterans with or without mild TBI.
- Operator for MRI data collection on the Siemens Prisma scanner.
- Managed telephone screening and eligibility assessment, obtained informed consent, and facilitated remote enrollment for participants.

Neurocognition and Movement Lab Research Assistant

| VA San Diego Healthcare

March 2024 - Present

Advisor: Dawn Schiehser, Ph.D., Professor of Psychiatry

- Assessed cognitive effects of mild to moderate traumatic brain injury (TBI) in individuals with Parkinson's disease (PD) (PD-TBI) through administration and scoring of neuropsychological tests (WMS-IV, CVLT-II, DOT-A, CWIT, DKEFS Verbal Fluency, JLOT-O, BNT-15) following strict protocols.
- Assisted with fMRI data collection; safety and operator trained on the Siemens Prisma scanner.
- Managed data cleaning and preprocessing for three large-scale longitudinal research datasets.
- Developed an Advanced Auto-Diagnosis Script for Mild Cognitive Impairment Detection.
- Adapted a imputation calculator to estimate missing scores on the UPDRS Part 3 (motor symptoms) for data cleaning.
- Train Research Assistants on administering and scoring neuropsychological assessments.

Kiyonaga Cognitive Neuroscience Lab Research Assistant

| UC San Diego Department of Cognitive Science

Sep 2023 - Present

Advisors: Anastasia Kiyonaga, Ph.D., Professor of Cognitive Science; Yueying Dong, Ph.D. candidate

- Designing and conducting 3+ eye tracking experiments centered on Visual Working Memory, aimed at investigating the presence and specificity of the Pupillary Near Response in young adults with normal cognition.
- Conducted eye tracking experiments focused on internally-prioritized Working Memory content, to understand the flexibility and specificity of the Pupillary Light Response in experiments involving 100+ young adults with normal cognition.
- 30+ presentations in Journal Club about how to utilize novel research in working memory, gaze, and pupillometry.
- 4+ programming/ coding projects to understand Pupil Processing Pipeline in Python.

CDC Community Liaison

| UC San Diego Department of Global Health

Sep 2023 - Feb 2024

Advisor: Mor Shilon, Ph.D., Professor of Urban Planning

- Interviewed 300+ residents of Logan Heights and the Logan Heights CDC to assess priorities for allocating state funding towards community issues through in-person interviews.
- Assisted in the production of a community film, art show, and awareness campaign.

ACADEMIC LAB AFFILIATIONS	Language and Infant Learning Lab UC San Diego Department of Cognitive Science March 2025 - Present Professor: Martin Zettersten, Ph.D., Assistant Professor of Cognitive Science • Develop a research proposal to investigate children's Social Networks. • Attended lab meetings and journal clubs.
	Vision and Memory Lab UC San Diego Department of Psychology Jan - July 2025 Head: Joseph Saito, Ph.D., Postdoctoral Researcher • Presented in journal club on geometry of visuospatial working memory and how sound alters visual perception.
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	Undergraduate Instructional Assistant UC San Diego PSYC 101: Developmental Psychology Sep - Dec 2023 Professor: Gail Heyman, Ph.D., Professor of Psychology • Led 10+ weekly, midterm, and final review sessions. Conducted personalized one-on-one sessions with 10+ students who were unable to attend live lectures. • Received unanimous student recommendations in course feedback surveys in the upper-division course.
	Undergraduate Instructional Assistant UC San Diego PSYC 102: Sensory Neuroscience Sep - Dec 2024 Professor: Nirelia Morantron, Ph.D., Adjunct Professor of Psychology • Held weekly office hours and 5 exam review sessions for 200 students. • Delivered a 1.5 hour lecture on the Anatomy of the Ear and Audition.
MENTORSHIP	UC San Diego • Prisha Desai, <i>Undergraduate Research Assistant</i> 2025 – Present • Amy Nguyen, <i>Undergraduate Research Assistant</i> 2025 – Present • Mira Mateo, <i>Undergraduate Student</i> 2024 – Present • Soobin Jones, <i>Honors Student</i> 2024 – 25 • German Lopez, <i>Transfer Student</i> 2024 – 25
SKILLS	Neuropsychological Assessments: BNT-15, D-KEFS, WAIS-IV, WMS-III, WMS-IV, MDRS, DOT-A, CVLT-II, JLOT, CWIT, RUFF, TOMM, BVMT, WRAT-4, WCST-64, WAIS, NAB, MINI Programming: R, SPSS, Python, JavaScript, HTML, MATLAB Libraries and Apps: PANDAS, Tidyverse, Haven, dplyr, ggplot2, MICE Psychophysics: Eye-Tracking Software (Eyelink), Psychopy, jsPsych Imaging Tools: Functional Magnetic Resonance Imaging (fMRI), Electroencephalogram (EEG) Languages: English, Cantonese, Mandarin Miscellaneous: RedCAP, Soldering, Adobe Photoshop, Arduino, Advanced Statistical Methods, VA Safety Trained, Trello, Qualtrics
PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS	• Student Member, International Parkinson and Movement Disorder Society 2024, 2025 • Student Member, American Geriatric Society 2024, 2025 • Student Member, Society for Neuroscience 2025

AWARDS	• Distinguished Undergraduate Researcher Award, UC San Diego	2025
	• Phi Beta Kappa	2025
	• Anderson Research Travel Award	2025
	• Thurgood Marshall Travel Award	2024
	• Provost Honors, UC San Diego	2021-2025